Indian and International Rivers and Tributaries

1. Major Indian Rivers and Their Tributaries

A. Himalayan Rivers

River	Major Tributaries	Notes
Ganga	Yamuna, Son, Ghaghara, Gandak, Kosi, Gomti, Chambal, Betwa, Ken	Largest river system of North India
Brahmaputra	Dibang, Lohit, Subansiri, Jiabharali, Manas, Tista	Important river of Northeast India
Indus	Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas, Sutlej	Originates in Tibet, flows through India and Pakistan

B. Peninsular Rivers

River	Major Tributaries	Notes
Godavari	Pravara, Manjira, Wainganga, Wardha, Pranhita, Indravati, Sabari	Longest peninsular river
Krishna	Tungabhadra, Bhima, Koyna, Musi, Ghataprabha	Major river of South India
Kaveri	Kabini, Bhavani, Amaravati, Hemavati, Arkavati	Famous for Cauvery delta
Narmada	Tawa, Barna, Banjar, Hiran	West-flowing river
Tapi	Purna, Girna, Panjhara	West-flowing river
Mahanadi	Seonath, Jonk, Hasdeo, Ib, Tel	Important river of Chhattisgarh and Odisha

2. Visual Memory Aid



Ganga • Brahmaputra • Indus • Godavari • Krishna • Kaveri

3. Important International Rivers and Their Tributaries

River	Continent	Major Tributaries
Nile	Africa	Blue Nile, White Nile, Atbara
Amazon	South America	Negro, Madeira, Japurá, Purus, Juruá
Danube	Europe	Tisza, Sava, Morava
Rhine	Europe	Main, Moselle
Volga	Europe	Kama, Oka, Vetluga
Yangtze	Asia	Yalong, Min, Jialing, Han
Mekong	Asia	Mun, Se Kong, Se San, Tonle Sap

4. Rivers Shared by India with Neighboring Countries

River	Shared With	Important Note
Indus	Pakistan	Starts in Tibet, enters India and then flows to Pakistan
Ganga	Bangladesh	Shared river system; important for both India and Bangladesh
Brahmaputra	China, Bangladesh	Known as Yarlung Tsangpo in Tibet
Teesta	Bangladesh	Important transboundary river in Northeast India
Mahakali	Nepal	Forms the India-Nepal boundary
Kosi	Nepal	Also called the Sorrow of Bihar
Gandak	Nepal	Important river in northern Bihar and Nepal
Sutlej	Pakistan	Flows from Tibet through India into Pakistan

5. Quick Memory Points

- The three major Himalayan river systems are Ganga, Brahmaputra, and Indus.
- Godavari, Krishna, and Kaveri are the major peninsular rivers.
- Narmada and Tapi are important west-flowing rivers.
- India shares important rivers with Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, and China.

6. One-Line Revision Capsule

- Ganga system: Yamuna, Son, Ghaghara, Gandak, Kosi.
- Brahmaputra system: Dibang, Lohit, Subansiri, Manas.
- Indus system: Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas, Sutlej.
- Godavari system: Pranhita, Indravati, Wainganga.
- Krishna system: Tungabhadra, Bhima, Koyna.
- Kaveri system: Kabini, Bhavani, Amaravati.